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Swatchh Bharat

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Swatchh Bharat

Key Observances and Milestones

- Swachhta Pakhwada is observed during the 2nd fortnight of November (**16th to 30th Nov**).
- National Post Day is celebrated on **10th October 2020**.
- A set of Three stamps on Swachh Bharat were released by Shri Ravi Shankar Prasad, Minister of Communications and Information Technology on **30 January, 2015**.
- India Post was awarded the First Position for the execution of the Swachhta Action Plan for the year **2018-19** during Swachh Mahotsav **2019** held on **6th September, 2019**. Shri Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, Union Minister for Jal Shakti handed over the award to India Post.

Achievements (1st Jan 2018 to 31st March 2019)

During the period from **1st Jan 2018 to 31st March 2019**, the following were achieved:

- Total **20** Post Office buildings were constructed.
- **650** Indian Post Payment Bank (IPPB) branches were established.
- **236** Post Office Passport Seva Kendra (POPSK) were set up.
- **2058** toilets were constructed.
- LED lights have been installed in **4245** Post offices.
- **50** Roof Top Solar Power Panels generating **11250 KW/day** were installed.
- Three solar power panels were installed in Postal Training Centre Madurai, Rafi Ahmed Kidwai National Postal Academy, and Dak Bhawan, New Delhi.
- **62** Postal Buildings were taken up for renovation to enhance their life.

- **121** Rain Water Harvesting Structures got constructed.
- During the Swachhta Pakhwada, a Swachhta pledge ceremony was held in **17448** Postal Offices, and a total of **65022** postal staff participated in shramdan.
- **815** iconic/tourist places were cleaned by way of community participation, and Cleanliness audits were done in **1993** offices.
- **7566** trees were planted, and three censuses were completed in **847** postal offices and postal colonies.
- **97** essay writing competitions on Swachhta were conducted.
- **5000** students participated for engaging in the Swachhta awareness campaign.
- **76** local public representatives got involved in Swachhta Pakhwada (**16-30 November 2018**).
- A total of **41** press conferences were held for highlighting the outcomes of Swachhta Pakhwada.
- Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Kerala Circles were awarded 1st, 2nd, and 3rd prizes for extraordinary work during Swachhta Pakhwada (**16th to 30th Nov 2018**).
- Nagpur, Hyderabad, and Mumbai GPO were awarded best performing buildings in lines of Energy Conservation under the category of green buildings by MNRE.
- Kolkata GPO was recognized by INTACH for the conservation of the Heritage Building.
- **318** post offices are declared as plastic-free.

Initiatives During Financial Year 2019-20

During the financial year **2019-20**, the following steps were taken:

- Creation of Task force at Circle/Division levels to conduct and monitor various cleanliness activities under the Swachh Bharat Mission.

- Nodal officers have been nominated in all **23** Circles to encourage and facilitate **2 hours** of voluntary "Shram Daan" per week for each employee in the Department.
- Awareness programs were created regarding the ban on the use of plastic bags, promotion of rain water harvesting techniques, and the use of solar energy through the social media wing.
- Other activities included conducting blood donation camps and conducting Swachhta Padyatra with the involvement of local representatives to spread awareness.

Swachhata in the Pandemic Era (2020-2021)

The advent of the global COVID-19 pandemic in the early months of 2020 necessitated an immediate, radical pivot in the interpretation and execution of Swachhata protocols. During the 2020-2021 fiscal period, the concept of cleanliness transitioned overnight from an aesthetic and environmental objective to an acute, life-saving public health imperative. The Swachh Bharat Mission nationally transitioned into Phase-II, focusing on ODF sustainability and Solid and Liquid Waste Management (SLWM). Concurrently, the Department of Posts was forced to fundamentally re-engineer its internal hygiene mechanics to ensure the safety of its essential workforce and the public.

Because the postal network remained operational during the most severe national lockdowns to deliver essential services, crucial financial remittances, and life-saving medical equipment, the DoP embedded unprecedented, stringent cleanliness protocols into its daily standard operating procedures. The observance of Swachhata Pakhwada and daily administrative routines became deeply focused on epidemiological biosecurity. Facilities integration included the widespread deployment of 70 percent alcohol-based sanitizers in every operational block and the installation of automated dispenser machines to maintain the health and hygiene of the staff. Administrative desks, sorting infrastructure, and high-touch public counters were subjected to rigorous cleaning protocols multiple times a day to prevent the spread of the novel coronavirus.

This rigorous physical sanitization was absolutely critical to support the massive surge in digital and decentralized financial services rendered by the postal network during the lockdown. The DoP played an instrumental role in facilitating Aadhaar Enabled Payment

Systems (AEPS) transactions. Acting in tandem with the banking sector, the postal network utilized microATMs to provide vital doorstep banking services, ultimately contributing to the execution of over 1362.59 crore successful AEPS transactions during this overarching period. Safely executing these high-volume, public-facing financial interventions required absolute adherence to the newly established Swachhata biosecurity protocols.

Furthermore, the pandemic accelerated the adoption of digital alternatives to physical administrative gatherings, indirectly contributing to the reduction of physical waste and administrative clutter. For instance, the inauguration of the 'Five Star Villages Scheme' — a critical initiative designed to ensure universal coverage of flagship postal schemes — was conducted entirely through advanced Video Conference (VC) solutions connecting Chief Post Masters General across India, bypassing the need for physical travel, paper-based event management, and the associated environmental footprint. The 2020-2021 period thus served as a brutal but highly effective stress test, proving conclusively that rigid bureaucratic environments could rapidly adopt, enforce, and sustain comprehensive, life-saving hygiene practices when mandated by necessity.

Special Campaign 1.0 (2021-2022)

The 2021-2022 fiscal year marked a profound paradigm shift in how the Government of India, and subsequently the Department of Posts, approached the concept of institutional cleanliness and administrative efficiency. Recognizing that physical clutter, disorganized workspaces, and bureaucratic pendency are mutually reinforcing phenomena that degrade public service delivery, the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG) launched Special Campaign 1.0 for the Disposal of Pending Matters, running from October 2nd to October 31st, 2021.

This national directive fundamentally redefined Swachh Bharat for the administrative and bureaucratic sectors. Cleanliness was no longer measured solely by sweeping corridors or administering pledges; it was rigorously quantified through highly specific, trackable metrics. These metrics included the weeding out of obsolete physical files, the closing of dormant e-files, the generation of revenue through the systematic disposal of scrap material, the freeing of physical office space in square feet, and the rapid liquidation of pending public grievances and inter-ministerial references.

During the execution of Special Campaign 1.0, the Department of Posts actively engaged its vast, decentralized network to aggressively reduce pendency and optimize its physical infrastructure. The campaign witnessed a concerted, highly coordinated effort across all regional postal circles to identify redundant paperwork, review decades-old physical files, and clear administrative bottlenecks that had persisted for years. The initiative demonstrated unequivocally that removing physical clutter from post offices directly correlated with a measurable reduction in service delays. The DoP ensured significant disposal of complex Public Grievances, addressed lingering references from Members of Parliament, responded to communications from State Governments, and fulfilled outstanding Parliament Assurances.

Simultaneously, the DoP was actively expanding its physical footprint into highly sensitive geographic areas, undertaking the approval and opening of 4,903 new Post Offices in Left Wing Extremism (LWE) affected districts to enhance financial inclusion and state presence. Managing the rapid deployment of these new assets required the simultaneous application of the new Swachhata space-management doctrines to ensure these frontier offices did not replicate the cluttered environments of older, legacy branches. Special Campaign 1.0 successfully set a rigorous baseline for data-driven cleanliness, establishing financial and spatial metrics that would become the absolute benchmark for all future iterations of the Swachhata drives across the postal network.

Special Campaign 2.0 (2022-2023)

Building systematically upon the foundational successes and operational learnings of the previous year, Special Campaign 2.0, executed in October 2022, adopted a highly aggressive "saturation approach." While earlier efforts often concentrated on ministerial headquarters in New Delhi, this iteration deliberately targeted outstation, subordinate, and remote field offices where public interface is highest. For the Department of Posts, this mandate meant activating strict cleanliness, scrap disposal, and file-weeding protocols not just in the central command of Dak Bhawan, but extending the rigorous mandate to the deepest rural branch post offices across the subcontinent.

The localized data emerging from the 2022 campaign illustrates a massive, highly enthusiastic mobilization of the grassroots postal workforce. Specific regional data from the Chennai City Central Division provides a granular, illuminating perspective on the

impact of these directives. In this division alone, the campaign's execution across 22 Sub Post offices resulted in the identification and disposal of 3,357 kilograms of obsolete, degrading physical records and 1,601 kilograms of mechanical and electronic scrap items.

The spatial and functional dividends of this localized effort were immediate and tangible. The Chennai operation successfully freed up 1,000 square feet of highly valuable urban real estate within these post offices. Crucially, the Department did not merely leave this space vacant; the freed spatial assets were strategically repurposed for employee welfare and operational expansion, specifically designated for the creation of staff retiring rooms and the extension of recreation facilities. To publicly reinforce the psychological shift toward cleanliness, wall arts depicting the critical importance of hygiene and sanitation were painted on the exterior complexes of the T. Nagar North Post office and the Mandaveli Post office, acting as permanent public awareness installations.

At the macro level, the national impact of Special Campaign 2.0 was staggering. Across the entire governmental apparatus, the campaign resulted in the redressal of 5.6 lakh public grievances, the weeding out of 37.50 lakh physical files, the freeing of 89.5 lakh square feet of space, and the generation of Rs. 370.1 crores through scrap disposal. Within this massive national effort, the Department of Posts emerged as a dominant executing agency. Secretariat Reforms reports indicate that out of the thousands of cleanliness campaigns conducted nationwide, the Department of Posts alone accounted for nearly 50 percent of the total, indicating incredibly strong, consistent, and unparalleled participation in Swachhata initiatives by the postal workforce. Furthermore, the DoP frequently led all other central ministries in the sheer volume of physical files weeded out, systematically dismantling the legacy architecture of paper-based bureaucracy.

The financial implications of this phase were substantial. By formally clearing out legacy scrap—ranging from broken mechanical weighing scales to obsolete first-generation sorting equipment, defunct vehicles, and accumulating e-waste—the postal ecosystem bypassed decades of institutional inertia surrounding asset write-offs. This period cemented the understanding that administrative Swachhata was not a cost center, but rather a highly lucrative revenue-generating mechanism.

Special Campaign 3.0 (2023-2024)

The operational trajectory of Swachhata initiatives within the Department of Posts reached unprecedented, historic heights during the 2023-2024 fiscal period under the banner of Special Campaign 3.0. Armed with the robust data collection mechanisms and operational frameworks refined during the previous two years, the DoP emerged as a top-performing entity across the entire governmental apparatus, achieving and frequently exceeding the highly ambitious targets established by the DARPG.

The physical scale of the operation during this phase was vast and highly coordinated. During the primary campaign window in October 2023, the DoP proactively targeted an astonishing 75,000 individual post offices for deep cleaning, scrap liquidation, and comprehensive organizational restructuring. The exhaustive statistical data reported during and immediately following this campaign reflects the massive magnitude of the postal sector's effort.

Performance Metric (Special Campaign 3.0)	Quantum Achieved
Cleanliness Campaign Sites Addressed (Oct 2023)	1,56,911 sites
Follow-up Sites Cleaned (Nov 2023 - Aug 2024)	15,931 sites
Physical Files Weeded Out (Oct 2023)	88,376 files
Cumulative Physical Files Weeded Out (by Aug 2024)	1,87,149 files
Total Physical Space Freed	88,844 sq. ft.
Revenue Earned via Scrap Disposal (Oct 2023)	Rs. 1.51 Crore
Revenue Earned via Scrap (Follow-up to Aug 2024)	Rs. 0.92 Crore
Pending Public Grievances Disposed	> 4.83 Lakh

The remarkable achievement of generating Rs. 1.51 crore strictly from the disposal of administrative scrap within a single, thirty-day operational window highlights the sheer volume of dormant, depreciating physical assets that had been languishing within the postal infrastructure. The subsequent, highly disciplined follow-up revenue generation of Rs. 0.92 crore collected between November 2023 and August 2024 demonstrates conclusively that the momentum generated during the October campaign was successfully sustained throughout the remainder of the fiscal year, transforming a temporary campaign into standard operating procedure.

Furthermore, the rigorous weeding out of nearly 1.87 lakh physical files by the end of August 2024 signifies a crucial, irreversible operational transition for the Department. The methodical review, digitization, and ultimate destruction of legacy paper records is an absolute, non-negotiable prerequisite for successful digital transformation. By clearing this massive volume of physical files, the DoP accelerated its adoption of modern e-Office systems, ensuring that future correspondence, policy formulation, and administrative decision-making processes occur in a frictionless, highly transparent, paperless digital environment.

The spatial reclamation achieved during Special Campaign 3.0—amounting to 88,844 square feet of freed office space—essentially created highly valuable new real estate within the confines of existing postal assets. This newly decluttered space was critical for the Department's strategic pivot toward modernized financial and logistics services. The execution of high-level Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) for the Centralized Integrated Payment System (CIPS) to overhaul postal payments required streamlined physical infrastructure. Uncluttered, hygienic spaces directly facilitated the rapid expansion of India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) physical touchpoints, Aadhaar enrollment and update counters, and the establishment of Dak Ghar Niryat Kendras—specialized hubs designed to facilitate commercial exports for MSMEs through postal channels.

Special Campaign 4.0 (2024-2025)

As the Swachh Bharat mission matured into the 2024-2025 fiscal cycle, the operational guidelines for Special Campaign 4.0 reflected a highly nuanced and progressive evolution in governmental thinking. The focus of the campaign expanded significantly beyond internal administrative housekeeping, file weeding, and scrap monetization to encompass broader mandates of ecological sustainability, active carbon footprint reduction, and the vital welfare of frontline sanitation workers.

During the execution of the Swachhata Hi Seva (SHS) 2024 campaign, which ran concurrently with the preparatory phases of Special Campaign 4.0, the Department of Posts seamlessly integrated environmental stewardship into its operational targets. Most notably, the Department orchestrated a massive, nationwide plantation drive, successfully planting over 36,000 trees under the banner of the national "#Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam" (A Tree in the Name of Mother) initiative. This represented a profound paradigm

shift; the DoP was no longer just cleaning its immediate indoor workspaces, but was actively engaging in afforestation to mitigate its logistics-related carbon footprint and contribute to local ecological health and urban canopy cover.

Simultaneously, the Department addressed the crucial human element of the sanitation ecosystem. Recognizing that the physical burden of maintaining 1.65 lakh offices falls on a dedicated cadre of custodial staff, the DoP organized Safai Mitra Suraksha Shivirs (Sanitation Worker Safety and Welfare Camps). These specialized camps functioned as single-window service centers, providing essential health checkups, preventative medical care, and targeted welfare services for sanitation workers, ensuring their health, safety, and dignity. This holistic, compassionate approach aligns perfectly with the deeper philosophical underpinnings of the Swachh Bharat Mission Phase-II, ensuring that rigorous sanitation efforts do not marginalize or compromise the welfare of those tasked with executing them.

Despite these new ecological and welfare mandates, the core quantitative administrative targets for Special Campaign 4.0 remained highly rigorous. Early assessments and finalized campaign data revealed that the DoP maintained its elite status as a highly efficient executing agency, routinely clearing pendency at an astonishing scale.

Performance Metric (Special Campaign 4.0)	Quantum Achieved
Cleanliness Campaign Sites Addressed (Oct 2024)	1,65,000 sites
Physical Files Thoroughly Reviewed	1,00,000 files
Physical Files Weeded Out	66,650 - 70,000 files
Electronic Files (e-files) Closed	326 e-files
Total Physical Space Freed	40,600 - 46,000 sq. ft.
Revenue Earned via Scrap Disposal	Rs. 69 Lakh
Pending Public Grievances Disposed	> 1,00,000

Parallel to the immediate, high-intensity efforts of the Special Campaign, the Department invested heavily in permanent, long-term infrastructure development to systematically eradicate the root causes of spatial congestion and poor hygiene. During this fiscal period, the DoP successfully completed the ground-up construction of 56 entirely new postal buildings and executed the extensive, modernization-focused renovation of 95 existing structures. These capital expenditure projects inherently resolved many localized, legacy

sanitation challenges by providing clean, well-ventilated, modern facilities equipped with proper sanitation amenities, directly improving service delivery for the public and providing a superior working environment for the staff. The successful nationwide introduction of electronic Know Your Customer (e-KYC) processes across all post office branches during this period further reduced the reliance on physical paper forms, structurally preventing the future accumulation of physical files.

Swachhta Hi Seva (SHS) Campaign 2025

- Planted more than **5,600** trees under the #EkPedMaaKeNaam initiative.
- Organised **273** Safai Mitra Suraksha Shivirs specifically for sanitation workers.
- Created **70** wall art installations on the exteriors of Post Offices.

Special Campaign 5.0 & Disposal of Pending Matters (SCDPM) *(Part of the Government's workplace cleanliness drive)*

- Freed up **45,000 square feet** of office space nationwide by clearing obsolete equipment and records.
- Generated a revenue of **₹ 1.02 crore** from the sale of scrap.
- Weeded out more than **17,352** old physical files and e-files.
- Successfully disposed of over **one lakh** public grievances and **1,000** CPGRAMS appeals.

Swachhta Action Plan

The following activities will be carried out under the Swachhta Action Plan:

- a) Potable Water Management: Installation of Water Purifier in RO/CO/DO and Post Offices.
- b) Putting interlock tiles in Post Office Courtyards.

- c) Solid Waste Management: Segregation of Organic and Inorganic Waste and e-Waste, including the installation of separate litterbins for Organic and Inorganic Garbage as well as e-waste litterbins at Post Offices and in Postal Colonies.
- d) Sanitization/Special Swachhta Initiative: Sanitization activities like the use of sanitizers and other hand hygienic activities, essay writing, debate, and Circle level poster competition on Swachhta, and prize distribution on a quarterly basis at the CO level, etc..
- e) Tree plantation in Post Offices Premises/Postal Colonies.

Fund Utilization

- Fund allotted to the Swachhta Action Plan may be utilized for the creation of long-term assets in the Swachh Bharat Mission.
- Perishable/consumable items may not be purchased for the Swachhta Action Plan (SAP) Fund; rather, those can be purchased for OE (Non-scheme).
- The Head of the Swachhta Action Plan is **5201.00.101.02.96.53 (GL-5101029653)**.

Swachhta Pakhwada Parameters and Activities

Ten Parameters have been formulated to assess the best **three** Circles as per their exemplary performance during Pakhwada for different activities. Based on these **ten parameters**, reports are received and Swachhta Pakhwada Awards (1st, 2nd, and 3rd position) shall be distributed:

- 1) No. of Webinars conducted and No. of participants participated on Swachhta organised by different offices in the Circle.
- 2) No. of Post Offices/ Branch offices/ mail Offices/ Administrative offices/ PTCS/DA(P) offices and Staff Quarters where cleanliness drive has been taken and No. of cleaning of toilets.
- 3) No. of Offices where cleanliness Audit has been taken.
- 4) Weeded out old records (In Kg) which have outlived preservation period.

- 5) No. of masks, sanitizers, soap and other safety-related products distributed.
- 6) No. of Posts/tweets etc. on twitter, Facebook, Instagram, YouTube to generate awareness.
- 7) No. of participants participated in online competitions like essay writing, Poster Competitions etc..
- 8) No. of pamphlets distributed to employees and customers having information, education and communication dissemination on better hygiene related to Covid-19 and cleanliness.
- 9) No. of stamps affixed on postal articles to curb the use of single use Plastic and discourage the use of plastics in the office.
- 10) No. of banners affixed on mail motors during Pakhwada.

Key Designations and Ceremonies

- Postmen/Postwomen may be designated as Swachhta Doot/Swachhta Ambassador during Pakhwada for generating awareness among customers at their doorstep.
- Special Felicitation Ceremony for housekeeping/cleaning staff working in Department of Posts.

Prescribed Activities During the Swachhta Pakhwada

- 1) Swachhta Pledge Ceremony, Augment letter box painting and Swachhta Logo on Postal Stationary.
- 2) Cleanliness drive may be taken in Post Offices/Branch offices/Mail Offices/Administrative Offices/PTCS/DA(P) Offices and Staff Quarters.
- 3) Awareness to the customers about cleanliness, social distancing, measures to prevent Corona Virus by affixing posters etc. in the office premises.
- 4) Cleaning of the Toilets in Postal Units and Centres and drainage system.

- 5) Cleaning of Rain Water Harvesting and Special Awareness Among Postal Employees for water conservation.
- 6) Weeding out of old records and Disposal of already condemned obsolete/unused items including e-waste following due procedures.
- 7) Cleaning in Postal Colonies and Postal training Centres, Cleanliness Audit.
- 8) Organise webinars on Swachhta.
- 9) Distribution of masks, sanitizers, soap and other safety related products.
- 10) Organise online competitions like essay writing, poster competition and received the representations by e-mail or WhatsApp.
- 11) Swachhta stamp with slogan as 'Say No TO Plastic Carry Bags' to be affixed on postal articles during Swachhta Pakhwada to curb the use of plastics in the office.
- 12) Use of different Social Media Platforms with Swachhta Messages.
- 13) Segregation of wet and dry wastages in the office premises.
- 14) Affix banners at Mail Motors displaying awareness about cleanliness.
- 15) A press release to be issued by HoCs and Directors on highlighting major outcomes of Swachhta Pakhwada fortnight and distribution of award among the offices for doing excellence work during the fortnight.